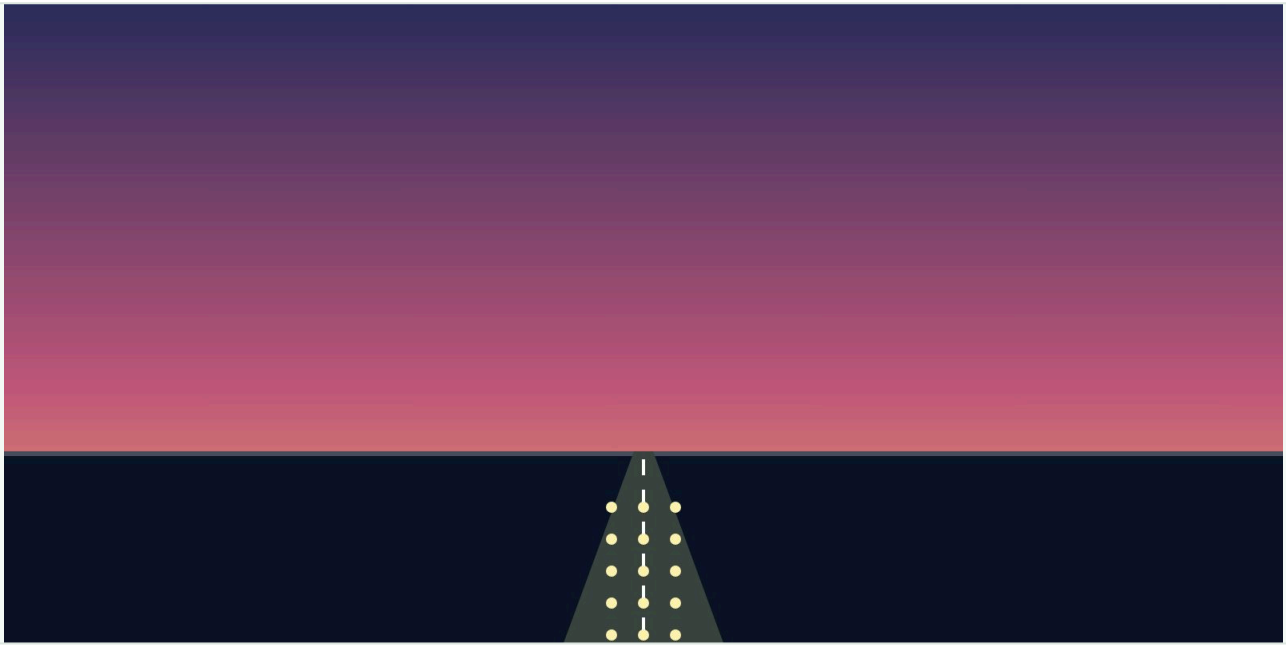
MODULE 1 · INOPERATIVE GROUND EQUIPMENT

# Lesson 01: Why Ground Equipment Matters

Lesson 1 of 3 · about 5 min

**LEARNING OBJECTIVES**

- Explain why published minima assume serviceable ground equipment.
- Identify how failures are notified.
- Describe the possible effects on an approach.



Minima assume serviceable aids and lighting.

## Minima assume serviceable equipment

Aerodrome operating minima are established for a runway with its navigation aids, lighting and RVR equipment serviceable (EASA CAT.OP.MPA.110; ICAO Doc 9365). When an item fails or is downgraded, the minima may have to be **increased**, or the approach may **not be available**.

## How you find out

- **NOTAM** — planned or known outages (e.g. ILS glide path unserviceable, approach lights out of service).
- **ATIS and ATC** — recent failures.
- Flight deck indications — loss of an ILS signal, flags, or visible lighting failures.

## Possible effects

- **No effect** — for example a failure that has an equivalent replacement (a marker replaced by a DME distance or another fix).
- **Higher minima** — for example an increased RVR when approach lights are out.

- **Downgrade** — for example from CAT II to CAT I, or from a 3D to a 2D approach (ILS to LOC only).
- **Approach not available**.

**COMPANY TABLE**

The effect of each failed or downgraded item on the minima is given in the **"failed or downgraded equipment" table of the Domestic Airlines OM A**. Use that table — this course explains how it works, not its values.

**KEY TAKEAWAYS**

- Minima assume serviceable ground aids, lighting and RVR equipment.
- Failures come from NOTAM, ATIS / ATC or flight deck indications.
- Effects: none, higher minima, downgrade, or no approach.

**KNOWLEDGE CHECK**

**The ILS glide path is out of service. What is the usual effect?**

A. No effect

B. The approach becomes a localiser-only (2D) approach with higher minima

C. CAT III becomes available

D. The runway closes

**Answer: B.** Without the glide path the ILS becomes a LOC-only 2D approach.

Training material only. It does not replace the Aircraft Flight Manual, FCOM, QRH, MEL or the Domestic Airlines Operations Manual, which always take precedence.